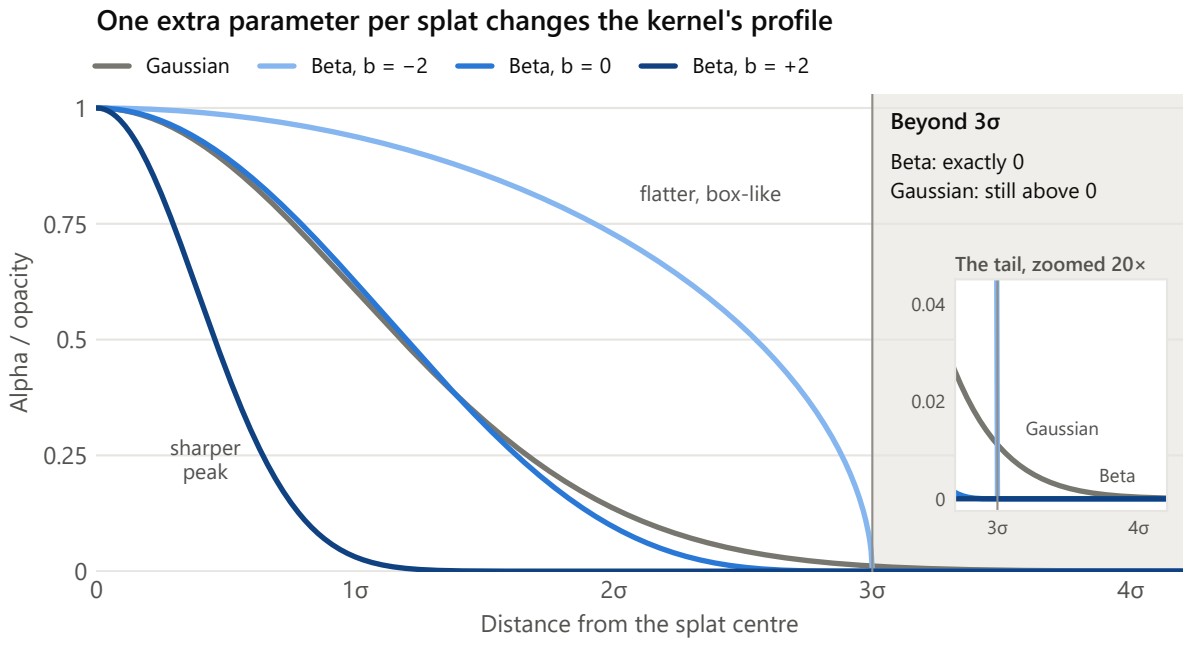
One extra parameter per splat changes the kernel's profile
Gaussian
Beta, b = −2
Beta, b = 0
Beta, b = +2
1
0.75
0.5
0.25
0
Alpha / opacity
flatter, box-like
sharper peak
0
1σ
2σ
3σ
4σ
Distance from the splat centre
Beyond 3σ
Beta: exactly 0
Gaussian: still above 0
The tail, zoomed 20×
0.04
0.02
0
Gaussian
Beta
3σ
4σ